

# Tutoring Centre Management System

## Client Meeting — Questions & Answers

### Answered

= Question answered from meeting transcript

### Still needed

= Still needs to be asked

## 1 About the business

### Context

**Q: How many students are currently enrolled, and how many do you expect to grow to?**

A: Current scale is relatively small (small enough to manage WhatsApp reminders manually). Growth scale not specified — still needed.

**Q: How many tutors do you have, and do they work full-time, part-time, or freelance?**

A: Tutors are session-based (paid per session/hourly). They currently use personal Gmail accounts. Exact number not stated.

**Q: What subjects or grade levels do you cater for?**

A: Selected subjects only — accounting and geography are NOT offered. Grades and levels are used to group learners. Specific subjects not fully listed in transcript.

**Q: Do you operate from one location or multiple branches?**

*Not discussed — confirm whether this is a single-branch or multi-branch operation.*

**Q: How do you currently manage all of this — spreadsheets, WhatsApp, a different system?**

A: Excel spreadsheets for applications and data. Google Calendar and Google Meet for scheduling. WhatsApp for parent communication. Manual EFT for payments.

## 2 Student application process

### Module 1

**Q: Walk me through how a parent currently enrolls their child — what steps are involved?**

A: Parent receives a PDF form, fills it out digitally or prints it, then emails or scans it back with payment details. Admin then manually enters data into Excel.

**Q: What information do you collect from the parent and student?**

A: Parent/guardian name, contact number, email, learner age, school name, current grade, subjects required, package choice. Supporting docs: latest school report and proof of payment.

**Q: Is there an assessment or placement test before a student is accepted?**

A: No formal assessment. Learners are placed by grade and level from the application form. Some applications are rejected if the subject is not offered.

**Q: Who reviews and approves applications — one person or a team?**

*Admin team reviews, but exact approval workflow and number of approvers not confirmed.*

**Q: How do you notify a parent that their application was approved or rejected?**

*Currently manual — likely WhatsApp or email. Confirm preferred notification channel and whether the system should automate this.*

**Q: Do parents need to upload any documents?**

A: Yes — latest school/academic report and proof of payment. No ID copy required.

**Q: Should parents be able to track their application status online?**

A: Yes — the system should show application status (paid, pending, confirmed) to both parents and admin after login.

**Q: Do students re-apply each term or year, or is enrolment ongoing?**

A: Applications are always open with no fixed closing date. Submissions happen continuously throughout the term.

### 3 Parent payments

#### Module 2

**Q: How do parents currently pay — EFT, cash, card?**

A: Primarily EFT. Card payments are not the main method. PayFast or an EFT-friendly gateway is preferred.

**Q: Is it a flat monthly fee, pay-per-session, or a package/bundle system?**

A: Package-based. Package A: monthly, 8 lessons + career guidance sessions. Package B: lighter, exam-prep oriented, paid per lesson or structured differently.

**Q: Do fees differ by subject, grade level, or tutor?**

A: Currently flat pricing across all subjects and levels. This may change as the business expands into different school phases.

**Q: Do you need to generate invoices automatically?**

A: Yes — the system should track subscriptions, statuses (paid/pending/confirmed), and allow export to Excel or PDF. Automated invoicing desirable.

**Q: Do you offer sibling discounts or payment plans?**

*Not discussed — confirm whether any discount structures need to be built into the system.*

**Q: How do you currently track who has paid and who hasn't?**

A: Manually via Excel. The new system should show payment status per parent/learner centrally.

**Q: Should the system send automatic payment reminders to parents?**

A: Short-term: manual WhatsApp reminders (small scale). Medium-term: automated email reminders (free/low cost, high volume). SMS/WhatsApp automation deprioritised due to Twilio cost.

**Q: Do you need integration with a payment gateway like PayFast or PayGate?**

A: Yes — PayFast discussed as the preferred option for EFT and potential recurring billing. Yoco also mentioned. Final gateway decision still to be confirmed.

**Q: Should parents be able to view their payment history and download receipts?**

*Likely yes given the portal vision, but not explicitly confirmed — raise this.*

## 4 Class scheduling

### Module 3

**Q: Are sessions one-on-one, small groups, or both?**

A: Small groups — tutor-to-learner ratio of 1:3, sometimes fewer. Learners grouped by subject, grade, and level.

**Q: Are sessions in-person, online, or a mix?**

A: Online via Google Meet. Students log in and join virtual classes. Long-term vision: join links appear directly in the platform when class time arrives.

**Q: How long are sessions, and how often does each student attend per week?**

*Not confirmed — Package A includes 8 lessons per month but session duration and weekly frequency not stated.*

**Q: Do classes follow a fixed recurring schedule, or do they vary each week?**

A: Currently recurring events on Google Calendar, manually created each week with links copied in. Fixed recurring preferred but currently time-consuming to manage.

**Q: Can parents book, reschedule, or cancel sessions themselves?**

*Not discussed. Clarify whether this is admin-only or self-service for parents.*

**Q: How much notice is required for a cancellation or reschedule?**

*Not discussed — define this policy before building cancellation logic.*

**Q: Should the system send session reminders to parents and students?**

A: Yes — currently Google Meet sends notifications. The new system should include session reminders, ideally tied to join links.

**Q: How do you handle public holidays or tutor absences?**

*Not addressed — confirm whether sessions are rescheduled, cancelled, or credited.*

**Q: Should attendance be tracked per session?**

A: Yes — admin currently checks manually whether sessions happened. The system should automate this tracking.

## 5 Tutor assignment & management

### Module 4

**Q: How do you currently decide which tutor gets assigned to which student?**

A: Allocated primarily by grade, level, and subject. Admin does this manually after reviewing the application.

**Q: Can a student have more than one tutor for different subjects?**

A: Yes — learners are grouped by subject and level, implying different tutors may cover different subjects.

**Q: Should the system suggest a tutor based on availability and subject match?**

A: Long-term yes — the vision is to automate allocation from the application form. Initially admin will still assign manually.

**Q: What information do you store per tutor? (qualifications, subjects, availability, rate)**

*Tutor rate is flat per session — confirm what other profile data needs to be captured and stored.*

**Q: Will tutors log into the system themselves to manage their availability or view their schedule?**

A: Yes — tutors are a named user role. Currently use personal Gmail; business wants org-managed accounts for security and control.

**Q: Do tutors submit session notes or progress reports after each session?**

A: Yes — tutors produce term reports covering learner performance, progress, strengths, and weaker areas. No formal exams; assessment is performance-based.

**Q: Are tutors paid per session, monthly, or on another structure?**

A: Per session. Tutors submit monthly log sheets (26th to 25th cycle). Logs treated as invoices; amount approved and paid at month end. Business wants to automate submission, review, and approve/reject workflow.

**Q: Does the system need to track tutor earnings or integrate with accounting?**

A: Yes — integration with SMEasy discussed so approved session data feeds automatically into finance/accounting records.

## 6 Roles, access & delivery

### Wrap-up

**Q: Who are the different types of users?**

A: Four roles confirmed: Admin, Parent, Learner (student), Tutor.

**Q: What should each user type be able to see and do — and what should they NOT have access to?**

*Roles are named but permissions per role not fully defined. Map this out before development begins.*

**Q: Does admin need a dashboard with an overview?**

A: Yes — admin wants central visibility over finance, subscriptions, parents, and learners from one console. Separate views for children, parents, subscriptions, and applications.

**Q: Should the system send notifications via SMS or WhatsApp, or only email?**

A: Email is primary (free, high volume). WhatsApp reminders manual for now (small scale). SMS/WhatsApp automation deferred due to Twilio cost.

**Q: What device do most of your parents use — phone or desktop?**

*Not confirmed — important for deciding whether to prioritise mobile-responsive design.*

**Q: Is there a hard go-live deadline or preferred launch date?**

*Not discussed — agree on a realistic timeline before scoping is finalised.*

**Q: After launch, who manages and maintains the system — your team or ours?**

*Not discussed — confirm support and maintenance arrangement.*

**Q: What does success look like 3 months after launch?**

A: Increased awareness and marketing reach identified as the main business challenge. Success = less admin burden, more organised data, and a platform that supports growth. Ongoing collaboration planned — not a one-off build.

## Summary — questions still to be answered

- 1 Do you operate from one location or multiple branches?
- 2 Who reviews and approves applications — one person or a team?
- 3 How do you notify a parent that their application was approved or rejected?
- 4 Should parents be able to view their payment history and download receipts?
- 5 Do you offer sibling discounts or payment plans?
- 6 Final payment gateway decision — PayFast confirmed or still evaluating?
- 7 How long are sessions, and how often does each student attend per week?
- 8 Can parents book, reschedule, or cancel sessions themselves?
- 9 How much notice is required for a cancellation or reschedule?
- 10 How do you handle public holidays or tutor absences?
- 11 What information do you store per tutor profile (qualifications, subjects, etc.)?
- 12 Permissions per user role — what can each role see and do?
- 13 What device do most parents use — phone or desktop?
- 14 Is there a hard go-live deadline or preferred launch date?
- 15 Who manages and maintains the system after launch?